



ARIZONA HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES FLOOR AMENDMENT EXPLANATION

57th Legislature, 2nd Regular Session

Majority Research Staff

HB2188: language acquisition grant program

WILLOUGHBY FLOOR AMENDMENT

1. Establishes the Grant Program consisting of monies appropriated by the Legislature to provide grants to listening and spoken language providers that provide auditory verbal services to AzEIP eligible infants and toddlers who are deaf or hard of hearing.
2. Requires DES to contract with listening and spoken language providers in Arizona to provide auditory verbal services to AzEIP eligible families with infants and toddlers who are deaf or hard of hearing.
3. Requires contractors ensure that the auditory verbal services are administered or overseen by a certified educator or therapist in a natural environment, clinical setting, educational setting or virtually.
4. Requires AzEIP to refer eligible families with children who are identified as deaf or hard of hearing to both of the following, at a minimum:
 - a. qualified providers within the Grant Program for listening and spoken language auditory verbal services; and
 - b. ASDB for visual language education through American Sign Language and any other modalities of communication available.

WILLOUGHBY FLOOR AMENDMENT
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES AMENDMENTS TO H.B. 2188
(Reference to HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES S/E Committee amendment)

Amendment instruction key:

[GREEN UNDERLINING IN BRACKETS] indicates text added to statute or previously enacted session law.

[Green underlining in brackets] indicates text added to new session law or text restoring existing law.

[GREEN STRIKEOUT IN BRACKETS] indicates new text removed from statute or previously enacted session law.

[Green strikeout in brackets] indicates text removed from existing statute, previously enacted session law or new session law.

<<Green carets>> indicate a section added to the bill.

<<Green strikeout in carets>> indicates a section removed from the bill.

1 The bill as proposed to be amended is reprinted as follows:

2 Strike everything after the enacting clause and insert:

3 "Section. 1. Title 41, chapter 14, article 5, Arizona Revised
4 Statutes, is amended by adding section 41-2023, to read:

5 41-2023. Language acquisition grant program

6 A. THE LANGUAGE ACQUISITION GRANT PROGRAM IS ESTABLISHED CONSISTING
7 OF MONIES APPROPRIATED BY THE LEGISLATURE TO PROVIDE GRANTS TO LISTENING
8 AND SPOKEN LANGUAGE PROVIDERS THAT PROVIDE [AUDITORY VERBAL] SERVICES TO
9 EARLY INTERVENTION PROGRAMS AND SERVICES ELIGIBLE INFANTS AND TODDLERS WHO
10 ARE DEAF OR HARD OF HEARING. MONIES IN THE FUND ARE SUBJECT TO
11 LEGISLATIVE APPROPRIATION. THE DEPARTMENT SHALL ADMINISTER THE GRANT
12 PROGRAM BY CONTRACTING WITH ELIGIBLE PROVIDERS AND MAY ADOPT RULES,
13 POLICIES AND PROCEDURES TO CARRY OUT THE PURPOSES OF THIS SECTION.

14 B. THE DEPARTMENT SHALL CONTRACT WITH LISTENING AND SPOKEN LANGUAGE
15 PROVIDERS IN THIS STATE TO PROVIDE [~~LISTENING AND SPOKEN LANGUAGE~~]
16 [AUDITORY VERBAL] SERVICES TO EARLY INTERVENTION PROGRAMS AND SERVICES
17 ELIGIBLE FAMILIES WITH INFANTS AND TODDLERS WHO ARE DEAF OR HARD OF
18 HEARING. CONTRACTORS SHALL ENSURE THAT THE PROVIDED [~~THERAPIES~~] [AUDITORY
19 VERBAL SERVICES] ARE ADMINISTERED BY OR OVERSEEN BY A CERTIFIED EDUCATOR
20 OR THERAPIST IN A NATURAL ENVIRONMENT, CLINICAL SETTING, EDUCATIONAL
21 SETTING OR VIRTUALLY.

22 C. THE EARLY INTERVENTION PROGRAMS AND SERVICES SHALL REFER
23 ELIGIBLE FAMILIES WITH CHILDREN WHO ARE IDENTIFIED AS DEAF OR HARD OF
24 HEARING TO BOTH OF THE FOLLOWING, AT A MINIMUM:

25 1. QUALIFIED PROVIDERS WITHIN THE LANGUAGE ACQUISITION GRANT
26 PROGRAM FOR LISTENING AND SPOKEN LANGUAGE [AUDITORY VERBAL] SERVICES.

27 2. THE ARIZONA STATE SCHOOLS FOR THE DEAF AND THE BLIND [~~TO LEARN~~
28 ~~AMERICAN SIGN LANGUAGE~~] [FOR VISUAL LANGUAGE EDUCATION THROUGH AMERICAN

House Amendments to H.B. 2188

1 SIGN LANGUAGE] AND ANY OTHER [FORM] [MODALITIES] OF [LANGUAGE ACQUISITION]
2 [COMMUNICATION AVAILABLE]."

3 Enroll and engross to conform

4 Amend title to conform

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03/04/2026

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